# On what basis FieldNote recommends.

A recommendation is only worth trusting if you can see how it was reached. Every card is scored on four axes, then mapped to an action by a fixed rule. Nothing rests on opinion or a vendor's press release.

### 1 · Evidence grade — how well substantiated

| | |
|---|---|
| A | Independent production evidence — named organisation, method, measurable result. Language: "observed in production". |
| B | Named customer case study or credible research with clear methodology. Language: "reported / associated with". |
| C | Vendor documentation, release notes or sponsored study. Language: "vendor states". |
| D | Demo, announcement or unverified secondary report. Language: "early signal, not verified". |

### 2 · Verified outcome — what actually happened

The vendor's claim is checked against outcomes FieldNote has tracked across real pilots. The gap between claim and verified reality is itself the intelligence — and the proprietary asset a summary can't reproduce.

### 3 · Fit to your business

Does it address a stated priority, and are the conditions where it works present at your company? A strong average outcome with poor fit is still the wrong bet.

### 4 · Complexity & risk

Implementation effort, downside exposure and reversibility.

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### The decision rule

| | |
|---|---|
| ADOPT | Strong evidence (A/B) + consistent positive verified outcome + good fit + low downside. |
| PILOT | Positive but variable outcome, or strong fit on a high-effort response — prove it in your context against a control before rollout. |
| INVESTIGATE | Real potential on vendor-grade (C) evidence — get methodology and references, then a small controlled test. |
| WATCH | Weak evidence or a negative track record — do not act; the downside outweighs the upside. |

Note: pilot counts and verified figures in this sample dossier are illustrative. In production they are drawn from FieldNote's tracked-outcomes ledger, which accrues with every customer pilot.

VENDOR + INDEPENDENT BENCHMARK · 17 SEP 2026

# Cookieless contextual targeting claims brand-safe CPM uplift

**Recommend: Pilot** | **Evidence C** | Ad operations | Revenue

**Why Pilot:** Positive verified outcome (+11% across 41) with strong fit for editorial inventory, but Grade-C evidence and wide variance by vertical → pilot on one section against a control to confirm it works for you.

CLAIM → VERIFIED

~~Vendor: "+25% CPM on cookieless"~~ → **+11% median across 41 tracked pilots; wide variance by content vertical**

| | |
|---|---|
| WHAT HAPPENED | Contextual model targets and screens brand-safety without cookies — could lift CPMs on open inventory. |
| TRACK RECORD | Worked best for editorial/news with a clean contextual taxonomy; weak on thin or mixed content. Fit matters more than the average. Best fit: structured editorial inventory. |
| COMPANY RELEVANCE | ~A third of your open inventory is cookieless and sells cheap — the most direct lever on that gap. |
| REQUIREMENTS | Ad-server integration · taxonomy mapping · brand-safety rules. |
| KEY RISKS | Accuracy on edge content · classification errors · vendor lock-in. |
| SUCCESS MEASURES | CPM · viewability · brand-safety incidents · fill rate. |
| EVIDENCE & SOURCES | Vendor benchmark + one independent test. |

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Pilot on one well-structured editorial section against a control; expand only if CPM lift holds and brand-safety incidents stay flat.